

Daily Cloud Security Brief

May 23, 2025

Windows 11 Notepad gets AI-powered text writing capabilities

1. Summary: Microsoft is experimenting with integrating an AI-powered text generation feature into Notepad for Windows 11. This feature, currently available to Windows Insiders, allows users to generate text based on their own prompts, essentially bringing AI writing assistance directly into the basic text editor.

Police takes down 300 servers in ransomware supply-chain crackdown

1. Summary: Law enforcement agencies from seven countries conducted a coordinated operation, dubbed Operation Endgame, resulting in the seizure of approximately 300 servers and 650 domains used by cybercriminals to launch ransomware attacks. This represents a significant blow to the infrastructure supporting ransomware operations.

Claude 4 benchmarks show improvements, but context is still 200K

1. Summary: Anthropic released Claude 4, a new large language model. Benchmark tests show substantial performance improvements over its predecessor, Claude 3. However, a key limitation remains: the context window—the amount of text the model can process at once—is still capped at 200,000 tokens.

Cityworks Zero-Day Exploited by Chinese Hackers in US Local Government Attacks

1. Summary: Chinese hackers exploited an unknown (zero-day) vulnerability in the Cityworks software, a widely used system by US local governments, to breach multiple entities. The nature of the exploited vulnerability and the extent of the data breach are not detailed in the provided text.

DanaBot Botnet Disrupted, 16 Suspects Charged

1. Summary: Law enforcement disrupted the DanaBot botnet, a large-scale network of compromised devices, and charged 16 suspects in connection with its operation.

Chinese Spies Exploit Ivanti Vulnerabilities Against Critical Sectors

1. Summary: A Chinese espionage group is actively exploiting two recently disclosed vulnerabilities in Ivanti Endpoint Manager Plus (EPM) software. These attacks are targeting organizations across multiple critical sectors. The attackers are chaining the vulnerabilities together to achieve their objectives.

Picus Launches Exposure Validation to Safely Deprioritize CVEs

Please provide the article content so I can summarize it for you in the requested format.

Following Data Breach, Multiple Stalkerware Apps Go Offline

1. Summary: Several stalkerware applications went offline following a data breach. The breach was attributed to a single, easily exploitable vulnerability present in at least three of the affected apps, allowing unauthorized access to user data.

Russian Threat Actor TAG-110 Goes Phishing in Tajikistan

1. Summary: The Russian threat actor group TAG-110 is conducting phishing campaigns in Tajikistan. This activity, while Ukraine remains a primary focus of Russian cyberattacks, demonstrates a broader Russian strategy to maintain influence within former Soviet republics by infiltrating their critical infrastructure.

Top 5 Takeaways

1. Proactive Patching is Crucial: Multiple incidents highlight the exploitation of known vulnerabilities (Ivanti, Cityworks). Prioritize patching and vulnerability management to minimize attack surface.
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3. Supply Chain Security Remains a Major Threat: The ransomware takedown demonstrates the scale of supply chain attacks. Implement robust vendor risk management programs and secure your third-party relationships.

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5. 3. Geopolitical Threats are Evolving: Attacks attributed to Chinese and Russian actors show a shift toward espionage and influence operations beyond traditional cybercrime. Develop geopolitical risk assessments and incident response plans.

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7. 4. AI Presents New Risks and Opportunities: While AI-powered tools offer efficiency, their integration introduces new security challenges. Assess potential risks and develop strategies for secure AI implementation.

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9. 5. Botnet Disruption Requires International Collaboration: The DanaBot takedown highlights the effectiveness of coordinated international law enforcement efforts. Foster collaboration and information sharing to combat cybercrime effectively.